

11. SAFETY & COMPLIANCE

11.1 DRIVER SAFETY

Pre-Trip Safety

Vehicle Safety Checklist (In-App):

Before every trip, driver must complete:

VEHICLE SAFETY CHECK

Job: PT-2025-001234

Required before accepting job

TIRES:

- ☐ All tires properly inflated
- ☐ Tread depth adequate
- ☐ Spare tire available and inflated
- ☐ Wheel nuts tight

LIGHTS:

- ☐ Headlights working (low & high beam)
- ☐ Brake lights working
- ☐ Turn signals working
- ☐ Hazard lights working

BRAKES:

- ☐ Brake pedal firm (not spongy)
- ☐ Hand brake working
- ☐ No unusual noises

FLUIDS:

- ☐ Engine oil level OK
- ☐ Coolant level OK
- ☐ Brake fluid level OK
- ☐ Windscreen washer fluid OK

SAFETY EQUIPMENT:

- ☐ Fire extinguisher (current, accessible)
- ☐ Warning triangles (2)
- ☐ First aid kit
- ☐ High-visibility vest
- ☐ Wheel chocks (if applicable)

CARGO AREA:

- ☐ Clean and dry
- ☐ No protruding objects
- ☐ Securing equipment available (straps, ropes)
- ☐ Tarpaulin (if needed)

DOCUMENTS:

- ☐ Driver's license
- ☐ Vehicle registration
- ☐ Insurance certificate
- ☐ VID certificate

PHONE & GPS:

- ☐ Phone charged (80%+)
- ☐ GPS working
- ☐ Emergency contacts saved

[COMPLETE CHECK] - All items must be checked

- **Cannot accept job until completed**
- **Random photo verification (system requests photo of specific item)**
- **Promotes safety culture**
- **Reduces breakdowns and accidents**

During Transit Safety

Fatigue Management:

Driving Time Limits:

- **Maximum 10 hours driving per day**
- **Mandatory 30-minute break every 4 hours**
- **Platform tracks driving time**
- **Alerts sent when limits approaching**
- **Cannot mark delivery if limits exceeded (emergency override available)**

Rest Area Suggestions:

- **Platform suggests safe rest stops**
- **Based on:**
 - **Route**
 - **Time of day**
 - **Driver fatigue level (estimated)**
 - **Upcoming rest areas**
- **Push notifications: "Rest area 10 km ahead"**

Night Driving Safety:

- **Extra caution alerts for high-risk routes**
- **Recommendations:**
 - **Reduce speed**
 - **Increase following distance**
 - **Avoid parking on roadside (hijacking risk)**

- Use well-lit, populated rest areas
- Emergency contacts highlighted

Speed Monitoring:

- GPS tracks vehicle speed
- Alerts if exceeding limits:
 - 20% over: Warning
 - 40% over: Strong alert + recorded
 - Persistent: Rating impact + review
- Not meant to micromanage, but promote safety
- Patterns reviewed (consistent speeding = concern)

Emergency Features:

SOS Button (Prominent in App):

- One-tap emergency alert
- Sends:
 - Current GPS location
 - Driver details
 - Job details
 - Emergency contact list
- Alerts:
 - Palmtrent 24/7 control center
 - Driver's emergency contact
 - Shipper (notified of incident)
- Control center takes action:
 - Calls driver immediately
 - Assesses situation
 - Dispatches help:
 - Police
 - Medical

- **Roadside assistance**
- **Security (if hijacking)**
- **Coordinates with insurance**
- **Updates all parties**

Incident Reporting:

- **In-app form for any incident:**
 - **Accident (minor or major)**
 - **Breakdown**
 - **Theft / Hijacking**
 - **Police stop**
 - **Cargo damage**
 - **Health emergency**
 - **Other**
- **Guided questions**
- **Photo upload**
- **Location auto-captured**
- **Timestamp recorded**
- **Creates support ticket**
- **Insurance claim initiated (if applicable)**

Post-Trip Safety

Delivery Safety:

- **Platform suggests safe offloading practices**
- **Checklist for proper handover**
- **Avoid leaving cargo unattended**
- **Confirm recipient identity**
- **Secure vehicle after offloading**

Return Journey:

- **Return load suggestions (avoid empty miles)**

- **Safe route recommendations (especially at night)**
 - **Rest area reminders**
 - **Fuel stop suggestions**
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11.2 CARGO SAFETY

Proper Loading

Loading Guidelines (In-App):

General Principles:

- **Distribute weight evenly**
- **Secure all items to prevent shifting**
- **Fragile items on top**
- **Heavy items on bottom**
- **Use padding for protection**
- **Don't overload vehicle (check weight limits)**

Cargo-Specific Instructions:

Bags (e.g., maize, sugar):

- **Stack in interlocking pattern**
- **Tie down with straps**
- **Use tarpaulin if open truck**
- **Check for tears/damage before loading**

Palletized Goods:

- **Use pallet jacks (don't drag)**
- **Secure pallets to truck bed**
- **Stack safely (not too high)**
- **Use straps around entire stack**

Fragile Items (electronics, glass):

- **Wrap individually**
- **Use padding (blankets, bubble wrap)**

- **Mark "FRAGILE" clearly**
- **Secure tightly (no movement)**
- **Avoid stacking heavy items on top**

Furniture:

- **Disassemble if possible**
- **Protect corners and surfaces**
- **Use moving blankets**
- **Secure to prevent sliding**
- **Separate pieces (prevent scratching)**

Liquids/Chemicals:

- **Ensure containers sealed**
- **Upright position**
- **Absorbent material underneath (in case of spill)**
- **Hazmat procedures (if applicable)**
- **Proper labeling**

Livestock:

- **Adequate ventilation**
- **Water available**
- **Space to move (not overcrowded)**
- **Bedding material**
- **Humane treatment (legal requirement)**

In-Transit Protection

Weather Protection:

- **Tarpaulin for open trucks (rain, dust)**
- **Temperature control (refrigerated goods)**
- **Shade (heat-sensitive items)**
- **Moisture protection (agricultural products)**

Theft Prevention:

- Lock cargo area (if enclosed)
- Park in safe, well-lit areas
- Don't leave vehicle unattended
- GPS tracking active (deters theft)
- Secure high-value items (hidden if possible)
- Avoid discussing cargo value publicly

Damage Prevention:

- Smooth driving (avoid sudden braking)
- Navigate potholes carefully
- Slow down on rough roads
- Check securing periodically (at rest stops)
- Re-secure if items shifted

Regular Inspections:

- Check cargo at rest stops
- Verify securing is intact
- Document any issues immediately
- Take photos if damage noticed
- Report to platform and shipper

11.3 REGULATORY COMPLIANCE

Zimbabwe Legal Requirements

Vehicle Operation:

Licensing:

- Driver must have valid Class 2 (or higher) license
- Commercial vehicle operation license
- All licenses current (not expired)
- Platform verifies before job acceptance

Vehicle Standards:

- **Current VID certificate (roadworthy)**
- **Annual ZINARA license (road tax)**
- **Insurance (minimum third-party)**
- **Vehicle registration up to date**
- **Compliance stickers displayed**

Road Rules:

- **Speed limits adhered to**
- **Load limits not exceeded**
- **Required stops (weigh bridges, VID checkpoints)**
- **Prohibited routes observed (weight/height restrictions)**
- **Toll payments (where applicable)**

Driver Conduct:

- **Zero tolerance for DUI**
- **Professional behavior required**
- **Compliance with traffic laws**
- **Cooperation with law enforcement**
- **Documentation carried at all times**

Cargo Regulations:

General Cargo:

- **Proper securing (not protruding)**
- **Weight distribution (axle load limits)**
- **Height restrictions (low bridges, power lines)**
- **Width restrictions (narrow roads)**
- **Documentation (waybill, permits)**

Restricted Goods:

Agricultural Products:

- **Phytosanitary certificates (plant products)**
- **Veterinary certificates (livestock)**

- **Movement permits (regulated areas)**
- **Quarantine compliance (disease outbreaks)**

Hazardous Materials:

- **Special permits required**
- **Certified drivers only**
- **Proper labeling and placarding**
- **Safety equipment (spill kits, etc.)**
- **Emergency response procedures**
- **Route restrictions (no residential areas)**

High-Value Goods:

- **Insurance mandatory**
- **Police escort (optional, for very high-value)**
- **Special security arrangements**
- **Detailed manifests**

Prohibited Items:

- **Illegal drugs**
- **Weapons (without permits)**
- **Counterfeit goods**
- **Stolen property**
- **Endangered species (without permits)**
- **Human trafficking (obviously)**

Platform Enforcement:

- **Prohibited items rejected automatically**
- **Restricted goods flagged for verification**
- **Documentation requirements checked**
- **Driver certifications verified**
- **Compliance monitoring throughout journey**

Cross-Border Compliance

Immigration Requirements:

- Valid passport (6+ months validity)
- Entry/exit stamps obtained
- Immigration forms completed
- Purpose of travel declared
- Visa requirements (if applicable to destination)

Customs Compliance:

- Commercial invoices accurate
- Packing lists complete
- Certificates of origin (duty exemptions)
- Customs declarations honest
- Duties paid (if applicable)
- No smuggling or false declarations

Vehicle Requirements:

- Yellow Card insurance (SADC/Comesa)
- Vehicle importation permit (temporary)
- All vehicle documents valid
- Roadworthy in destination country
- Compliance with foreign regulations

Cargo Restrictions:

- Import/export permits (where required)
- Prohibited items by destination country
- Quantity restrictions
- Sanitary/phytosanitary requirements
- Customs bonds (high-value goods)

Platform Support:

- Pre-clearance guidance
- Documentation checklists

- **Border requirements by country**
 - **Real-time border wait times**
 - **Customs broker connections**
 - **24/7 border assistance hotline**
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11.4 INSURANCE COMPLIANCE

Mandatory Insurance

For Transporters:

Third-Party Liability (Minimum):

- **Covers injury/death to third parties**
- **Property damage to others**
- **Legally required for vehicle operation**
- **Minimum coverage: USD \$10,000 public liability**
- **Platform verifies before job acceptance**
- **Renewal tracking and reminders**

Comprehensive (Recommended):

- **Own vehicle damage**
- **Theft and hijacking**
- **Fire and natural disasters**
- **Goods in transit (up to limit)**
- **More comprehensive protection**
- **Preferred by most shippers**
- **Lower platform commission eligibility**

Yellow Card (Cross-Border):

- **Mandatory for SADC/Comesa travel**
- **Third-party liability in foreign countries**
- **Valid for trip duration (usually 30 days)**
- **Platform verifies before cross-border jobs**

- **Purchase facilitated through platform**

For Cargo:

Per-Shipment Insurance:

- **Optional for shipper**
- **Strongly recommended for high-value**
- **Covers loss, damage, theft**
- **Easy claims process**
- **Fast payouts (48-72 hours typically)**

Annual Policies:

- **For frequent shippers/corporate accounts**
- **Cost-effective for regular shipments**
- **Comprehensive coverage**
- **Preferred provider rates**

Claims Support

Palmtrent's Role:

Claims Assistance:

- **Document incident thoroughly**
- **Collect all evidence (GPS, photos, statements)**
- **Package information for insurer**
- **Submit claim on behalf of user**
- **Follow up regularly**
- **Advocate for fair settlement**
- **Mediate disputes with insurer**

Evidence Collection:

- **GPS data (route, timing, stops)**
- **Photos (pickup, transit, delivery)**
- **Proof of delivery (signatures)**
- **Messages (communication record)**

- **Police reports (if applicable)**
- **Witness statements (if available)**
- **Vehicle condition reports**

Claims Process:

1. Incident Reported

- └─ **User reports via app**
- └─ **Palmtrent case opened**
- └─ **Evidence collection begins**

2. Initial Assessment

- └─ **Review evidence**
- └─ **Determine liability**
- └─ **Estimate damage value**
- └─ **Identify insurance coverage**

3. Claim Submission

- └─ **Prepare claim package**
- └─ **Submit to insurer**
- └─ **Provide reference number**
- └─ **Set expectations (timeline)**

4. Insurer Review

- └─ **Surveyor assigned (if needed)**
- └─ **Site inspection (if needed)**
- └─ **Evidence evaluation**
- └─ **Liability determination**

5. Settlement

- └─ **Claim approved/denied**
- └─ **Payment amount determined**
- └─ **Payout processed**
- └─ **All parties notified**

Timeline:

- └─ **Simple claims: 48-72 hours**
 - └─ **Complex claims: 5-7 days**
 - └─ **Disputes: Up to 30 days**
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11.5 PLATFORM SAFETY POLICIES

Zero Tolerance Policies

Immediate Account Termination:

Fraud:

- **Fake documents**
- **False identity**
- **Payment fraud**
- **Insurance fraud**
- **Rating manipulation**
- **GPS spoofing**

Criminal Activity:

- **Theft of cargo**
- **Hijacking**
- **Drug trafficking**
- **Human trafficking**
- **Violence or threats**
- **Extortion**

Serious Safety Violations:

- **DUI (driving under influence)**
- **Reckless driving causing accident**
- **Gross negligence**
- **Willful damage to cargo**
- **Abandoning cargo**

Discrimination:

- **Refusal based on race, religion, gender, etc.**
- **Hate speech**
- **Harassment**
- **Discriminatory behavior**

Three-Strike Policies:

Minor Offenses (Warnings → Suspension → Ban):

- **Late deliveries (chronic)**
- **Poor communication**
- **Unprofessional conduct**
- **Minor cargo handling issues**
- **Payment delays (drivers remitting commissions)**
- **Document submission delays**

Progressive Discipline:

Strike 1: Warning

- └— **Formal notification**
- └— **Explanation of issue**
- └— **Coaching/guidance**
- └— **Documented in account**
- └— **Monitoring period (30 days)**

Strike 2: Suspension

- |— Account suspended (7-30 days)
- |— Additional training required
- |— Review of all past jobs
- |— Reinstatement conditions set
- └— Probation period (90 days)

Strike 3: Permanent Ban

- |— Account terminated
- |— Cannot re-register
- |— Outstanding payments settled
- |— All parties notified
- └— Blacklist (prevent re-entry)

Safety Training

Mandatory Training (Before Activation):

For Drivers:

- Platform orientation (2 hours)
- Safety procedures
- Cargo handling best practices
- Professional conduct
- Communication skills
- Emergency procedures
- GPS and app usage
- Documentation requirements
- Quiz (80% pass required)

Ongoing Training:

- Quarterly safety refreshers (online)
- New feature training (when launched)
- Regulatory updates

- **Incident case studies**
- **Best practice sharing**
- **Optional advanced courses:**
 - **Defensive driving**
 - **First aid**
 - **Hazmat handling**
 - **Cross-border procedures**

For Shippers:

- **Platform tutorial (30 minutes)**
- **Booking best practices**
- **Communication guidelines**
- **Documentation requirements**
- **Dispute prevention**
- **Insurance guidance**

Safety Reporting

Incident Reporting System:

- **Easy in-app reporting**
- **Anonymous reporting option (for witnesses)**
- **Confidential handling**
- **Thorough investigation**
- **Timely resolution**
- **Feedback to reporter**
- **Preventive action taken**

Safety Metrics Dashboard:

- **Platform-wide safety statistics**
- **Incident rates (per 1,000 jobs)**
- **Response times**
- **Resolution rates**

- **Trends and patterns**
- **Shared with users (transparency)**